

Safety and Risk Management

TCS3111

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The Integrated approach and benefits

- An integrated approach is a comprehensive, management systems approach to **worker safety, health, and well-being that's shaped by employee input and participation.**
- This approach has a great strength—is a sharp focus on using **policies and practices to influence working conditions**, which are often the drivers of safety, health, and well-being issues.
- A systems approach can demonstrate how multiple factors contribute to health and safety issues.
- Looking further upstream may allow you to address root causes instead of just symptoms. A comprehensive approach that's collaboratively designed and implemented is the most effective path to improved safety, health, and well-being outcomes. And it can positively impact employer outcomes, as well.



Key Characteristics

An effective integrated approach is based on six key characteristics:

- **Leadership commitment:** Leadership makes worker safety, health, and well-being a clear priority for the entire organization. Leaders drive accountability and provide the necessary resources and environment to create positive working conditions.
- **Participation:** Stakeholders at every level of an organization, including employees and organized labor, help plan and carry out efforts to protect and promote worker safety and health.
- **Policies, programs, and practices focused on positive working conditions:** The organization enhances worker safety, health, and well-being with policies and practices that improve working conditions.



Key Characteristics

- **Comprehensive and collaborative strategies:** Employees from across the organization work together to develop comprehensive health and safety initiatives.
- **Adherence:** The organization adheres to federal and state regulations, as well as ethical norms— such as a respectful workplace—that advance worker safety, health, and well-being.
- **Data-driven change:** Regular evaluation guides an organization's priority setting, decision making, and continuous improvement of worker safety, health, and well-being initiatives.



Integrated Leadership and Collaboration

- Buy-in and collaboration from across your organization are vital to the viability and sustainability of an integrated approach.
- It is important , **leaders who show clear commitment to improving working conditions, managers who facilitate the process, and workers at all levels who provide input and participate in your initiative.**



Integrated Leadership and Collaboration

To build support for an integrated initiative,

- **Seek top leadership support early on**

Leadership can set the tone for new initiatives, **influence management and employees, commit resources, and create supportive environments**. Such actions demonstrate a clear commitment to worker health and safety and serve as an essential driving force behind an integrated initiative.

- **Encourage collaboration.**

Whether you create an integrated approach team or tap into another collaborative effort within your organization, diverse perspectives and expertise can help with everything from planning the initiative to continual improvement.



Integrated Leadership and Collaboration

- **Work closely with middle managers.**

Middle managers often hold the keys to successful implementation of an integrated initiative because they directly manage both workflow and employees. It's critical that they understand how to support both the effort and their workers.

- **Give workers clear opportunities to participate.**

Involving workers in your initiative is a key characteristic of an integrated approach. You'll need to show employees that their involvement will lead to substantive change and improved outcomes.



Integrated Planning

- Successful initiatives typically start with a clear, thorough plan.
- The steps outlined below are typical of many detailed planning processes, integrated planning focuses on working conditions to improve employee safety, health and well-being.
- It also emphasizes comprehensive solutions, collaboration, and participation by all levels of employees.



Key steps

- **Define your goal.** An effective goal provides direction for your team. When you align the initiative's goal with your organization's mission and business objectives, you also increase the odds that you'll get buy-in and support from across your organization.
- **Choose SMART objectives.** SMART objectives—Specific, Measurable, Attainable, Relevant, and Time-bound—help you get the most from your process. They drive accountability and clarify what you want to accomplish.
- **Identify relevant working conditions.** By targeting working conditions, you work at the systems level and focus on the root causes of health and safety issues.



Key steps

- **Gather and analyze essential worksite information.** Focused information gathering gives you a baseline to measure progress, verifies your choice of objectives and working conditions, and helps you select and prioritize your tactics.
- **Select tactics to achieve your objectives.** Your tactics influence which policies and practices you'll need to create or change to improve working conditions.
- **Create an action plan.** A well-crafted plan charts your course and drives accountability. It also guides efforts to track progress, allowing you to identify areas that need improvement.
- **Identify required resources.** Consider especially if staff needs to be hired or tasks reassigned, and if new funds are required for items like changes to the physical environment, new employee benefits, or training costs.



During your planning process:

- Make sure to reach out to those impacted by the initiative, including workers, as they may offer critical suggestions and solutions.
- Contact those who need to be convinced about the initiative's value and invite them into the process.
- Allow for plenty of time and discussions around planning. This early effort may help prevent later surprises or roadblocks.



Integrated Implementation

- **Start small.** Do a trial run of your plan before scaling up more widely. You'll likely learn important lessons in these first steps, allowing you to tweak your tactics before making broader changes.
- **Change working conditions through policies and practices.** For instance, to increase the use of mechanical lifts in areas where moving heavy items is common, you can use worker and management input to implement standard operating procedures for lift use, inspection, and maintenance.
- **Monitor progress.** It's important to track progress toward your objectives and to check how the process itself is going. You'll learn not only if your tactics are working, but also why, which helps make your process even more effective.



Integrated Implementation

- **Review accountability procedures.** During implementation, it helps to examine the procedures you put in place to ensure that all those responsible for implementing an integrated approach know their roles and are held accountable.
- **Communicate with leadership, management, and employees about progress.** This helps maintain interest and build support and participation for an integrated approach.
- **Train employees for successful implementation.** Weave integrated approaches into your existing trainings. And, consider training all levels of employees, including management, on their roles in protecting and promoting worker safety, health, and well-being.



As you go along, remember to:

- **Give employees opportunities to participate in implementation—** this is critical for your initiative's long-term success.
- **Use existing processes.** For example, continuous or quality improvement processes in industries such as health care or manufacturing, or pre-task planning in construction, can serve as great platforms for an integrated approach.
- Engage leaders in an on-going way through frequent meetings and communications.



As you go along, remember to:

- Communicate often—you'll build trust and support, gain valuable insight, and increase participation.
- Identify the resources you need. If some employees take on new responsibilities, consider shifting their responsibilities to prevent work overload.
- Listen to stakeholders. Workers and managers at all levels can provide critical insights. It helps to listen closely to their input and keep an open mind to changing which tactics and working conditions the initiative focuses on. If key stakeholders aren't participating, talk to them and address their concerns



Integrated Evaluation and Improvement

- **Remember the key characteristics of an integrated approach.** This will help keep your efforts focused on working conditions.
- **Use a variety of data collection methods.** You'll develop a more complete picture of the issues at hand when you gather evaluation data in multiple ways, such as surveys, walk-throughs, and conversations with employees.
- **Limit how much data you collect.** Focus just on the data that helps you evaluate the objectives, working conditions, and tactics in your action plan.



Integrated Evaluation and Improvement

- **Form a diverse evaluation team.** A team with a variety of backgrounds, skills, and experience gives you a wider range of perspectives and insights.
- **Evaluate as needed.** There's no formula for how often to evaluate your initiative. It's based on your objectives and capacity, and it may change over time.
- **Communicate often.** Regularly share the results of your findings and ask for feedback.
- **Let the data guide you.** Your evaluation results help determine your next steps so you can continually improve your initiative.



Benefits

1. Improving Performance
2. Eliminating Redundancies
3. Accountability
4. Establishing Consistency
5. Reducing Bureaucracy
6. Cost Reduction
7. Optimize Processes and Resources
8. Reducing Maintenance
9. Integrated Audits
10. Facilitating Decision Making



Company Policy Statement and Policies



Value systems and cost Benefit



Regulations and professional responsibilities

